

Nikon D3000

The D3000 was brought in to replace the D60 and the popular D40 and D40X models. The D3000 sells with an 18-55mm lens that you find in most stock kits on DSLR cameras. The more expensive the camera, the less likely you are to get a lens kit. Users are then expected to choose a lens of their preference.

The focus motor isn't on the body, so the lens has it inbuilt. Make sure that any lens that you purchase in the future has an inbuilt focus motor or you'll miss out on the auto-focus function.

There is no Liveview on the camera. Its competitor, the Canon EOS 1000D has Liveview. While many professionals dismiss the Liveview function, for beginners, it's a simpler way of using the camera.

The 11-point focus system makes auto-focusing a little simpler and quicker.

For those who are new to photography and need something that can help them find their way around, the Guide mode makes operating the camera slightly simpler. The controls are simple to use and unlike the costlier DSLRs, there is no dedicated ISO button or two jogdials on the D3000, so you're forced to use a few more buttons while shooting. Some of the buttons can be customised to be used with the jogdial for other functions.

Nikon D5000

The body of the D5000 has some similarities with the D3000. The D5000 includes a foldable LCD screen that also makes the camera slightly bulkier. The base of the camera towards the LCD has become bulkier. This means Nikon has been only able to fit a 2.7-inch screen on the



Nikon D5000

camera. The cheaper D3000 comes with a 3-inch screen, but no Liveview. The D5000 feels like a downgrade in that aspect. In other aspects, it's an upgrade – higher resolution, better ISO range, burst speed shooting rate, etc.

All the bay doors are sturdy and there's no chance of the plastic/rubber straps holding them of breaking.

One of the other less important features is GPS that records coordinates of the location of the photo. You need to buy an optional GPS unit from Nikon for that. The HD 720p video recording feature is unique and possible with the Liveview function.

Nikon D300s

The Nikon D300s is where things get a lot more serious. The size and weight of the camera is indicative of that. There's a big difference going from the D5000 to this. The older D300 had no Liveview so there was no video recording functionality either. It's still no a full-frame sensor camera though. The D300s like the D5000, records 720p video.

The camera has a high-quality 3-inch non-foldable display and many more controls. It includes a top-view display for the controls, so you don't have to look at the screen at the back while switching controls. Dedicated buttons for all the other controls along with the two jogdials control pretty much everything. You rarely use the direc-



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